Keeno Smith

Cloud Engineer | Cloud-Native Applications & DevOps

AWS · Azure · Google Cloud · Docker · Terraform · CI/CD · Reliability

Cape Town · Johannesburg

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Professional Summary

Cloud-focused Software Engineer with 6+ years of software and digital engineering experience developing cloud-ready applications, APIs and distributed services. Work across AWS, Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud integration patterns, with practical Docker, Terraform, Kubernetes configuration, Python, TypeScript, Go and SQL skills. Combine application engineering with infrastructure, automation and operational reliability.

Experience includes containerised services, cloud integration adapters, infrastructure-as-code definitions, event-driven processing and deployment preparation. Apply GitHub Actions, environment configuration, least-privilege access, secrets handling, monitoring, tracing, retries and recovery checks. Translate application requirements into secure, maintainable architectures, with local verification and cloud deployment status documented accurately.

Technical Skills

Cloud platforms and services: AWS (EventBridge, SQS, S3, Bedrock, SageMaker, IAM); Microsoft Azure (Foundry, Activity Logs, diagnostics); Google Cloud (Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, BigQuery, Vertex AI)

Infrastructure and containers: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes manifests, kind, Terraform, Cloud Build, Artifact Registry, Nginx, infrastructure as code, service configuration

DevOps and delivery: Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, automated builds and tests, deployment preparation, environment configuration, secrets management, health checks, migration workflows

Cloud-native and backend: Python (3+ years), FastAPI, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, Go, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka/Redpanda, RabbitMQ, event-driven systems

Observability and resilience: OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, logging, monitoring, distributed tracing, k6, Toxiproxy, idempotency, retries, disaster recovery

Security and integration: IAM, RBAC, least privilege, authentication, authorisation, API integration, webhooks, signed events, network isolation, TLS, incident investigation

Experience

Python and Full-Stack Engineer in AI Training and Evaluation

Turing / OpenTrain AI | February 2026 – Present

Contribute Python and JavaScript/TypeScript engineering to AI training and technical evaluation workflows, reviewing code quality, reproducibility, testing and secure execution practices.

- Develop, review and debug Python and TypeScript solutions, validating edge cases, automated tests and repeatable execution across local and Docker environments.
- Evaluate implementation correctness, dependency assumptions, error handling and security concerns; document reproducible defects and technical risks.
- Prepare structured engineering examples and review feedback for supervised fine-tuning (SFT), RLHF and model evaluation workflows.

Experience Continued

AI Engineer

kailor | February 2025 – Present

Engineer AI-enabled software and backend services with secure integrations, persistent state and operational workflows, designing cloud-ready application boundaries and deployment considerations.

- Design Python and TypeScript APIs, integration services and data workflows with clear contracts, configuration and deployment requirements.
- Build automation for enquiries, administration and recurring tasks using API integrations, durable application state and controlled execution.
- Translate business processes into service architectures, integration plans and practical cloud or third-party technology recommendations.
- Apply role-based permissions, input validation, secrets handling, retries, failure recovery and audit trails to application workflows.
- Test integrated services, diagnose operational failures and document architecture, deployment dependencies and reliability trade-offs.

Full-Stack Software Engineer & AI Publisher

kailor | June 2022 – January 2025

Developed full-stack web applications and digital publishing systems, integrating frontend delivery, backend services, persistent data and hosted business tooling.

- Built React and JavaScript applications, Node.js APIs, authentication and database-backed features designed for reliable service integration.
- Integrated publishing workflows and external platforms; automated repeatable content and operational tasks using APIs and managed services.
- Improved deployment readiness, stability and maintainability through configuration management, testing, debugging and iterative releases.

Technical and Digital Operations Lead and Co-Founder

Firstdaes Entertainment | January 2020 – June 2022

Co-founded an entertainment business and led its digital systems, workflow design and technology-enabled operations.

- Translated operational needs into technical requirements; managed implementation, testing and troubleshooting of digital services.
- Integrated communications, marketing and analytics tooling; used performance data and operational feedback to refine processes.

Contract Specialist in Technical Content and Documentation

3Play Media | February 2016 – January 2020

- Reviewed, transcribed and edited specialist material covering software, cloud, networking and cybersecurity, preserving technical terminology and accuracy.
- Resolved ambiguous content and maintained quality and delivery standards across assignments for enterprise technology subject matter.

Education

Stellenbosch University: Generative AI Mini Bootcamp | June – September 2026

HyperionDev: Full-Stack Software Engineering and Web Development | January – June 2026

University of South Africa: BSc Computer Science | 2017 – 2022

Selected Projects

Independent cloud-oriented projects demonstrating provider integration, infrastructure as code, containerised delivery, observability and resilience.

AWS Banking & Payment Risk Platform

AWS SDK · Terraform · EventBridge · SQS · S3 · Bedrock · SageMaker · Node.js · PostgreSQL

Engineered a locally validated payment-risk application with AWS integration adapters for EventBridge, SQS, S3, Bedrock, SageMaker and optional Secrets Manager/KMS. Authored Terraform for an event bus, queues, dead-letter handling, storage and IAM policies. Implemented idempotent transactions, secure configuration and integration tests; cloud provisioning and live AWS calls remain unverified.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/aws-ai-banking-and-payment-risk

Google Cloud Retail & Supply Chain Platform

Google Cloud · Terraform · Cloud Run · Cloud SQL · Pub/Sub · BigQuery · GCS · FastAPI

Developed a containerised retail planning system with FastAPI, PostgreSQL, persistent jobs and event-driven processing. Implemented optional Google Cloud provider integrations and Terraform definitions for Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Pub/Sub, BigQuery, storage, service accounts and IAM, with Cloud Build configuration. Validated local workflows; paid cloud resources were not deployed.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/gcp-ai-retail-and-supply-chain

Microsoft Azure AI-Powered DevOps Operations

Azure · Microsoft Foundry · Python · FastAPI · GitHub APIs · Webhooks · MongoDB · Docker

Built an engineering-operations application connecting GitHub evidence, Azure resource inventory, Activity Logs and scoped diagnostics to durable incident workflows. Integrated a Python agent runtime, signed webhooks, review/approval stages, verification history and secure API boundaries. Tested local lifecycle and provider contracts; live Foundry execution and production Azure deployment require configuration.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/microsoft-ai-powered-software-engineering-devops

Distributed Systems Reliability & Disaster Recovery

Docker · Kubernetes manifests · Go · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · Prometheus · Grafana · k6

Built a containerised reliability testbed with service health metrics, tracing, controlled fault injection and transaction recovery. Used durable messaging, retries, idempotency and a transactional outbox; verified failure behaviour and isolated PostgreSQL backup restoration. Added Kubernetes deployment manifests, with local Compose operation validated and cluster deployment separately unverified.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/sre-chaos-engineering

Selected Credentials and Professional Development

Microsoft AI: AI-103 — Azure AI Apps and Agents Developer Associate | Completed October 2026; AI-500 | In progress; Microsoft Applied Skills — Defender XDR

Generative AI and engineering: WeThinkCode_ Generative AI for Professionals | October 2026; Generative AI for Software Engineers; AI Course for Developers; AWS AI/ML Scholars AI Practitioner and AI Programmer Nanodegree

Automation and related training: n8n Workflow Automation and AI; Microsoft × Founderz Cyber Genius; Founderz Agent Architect (enrolled); IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner; Make Agentic AI Work for You; Google Cloud Kubernetes